Warehouse Safety SOPs

Field	Detail
Company	Indus Freight Lines (Pvt.) Ltd.
Document ID	IFL-SAF-004
Version	1.1
Effective date	1 March 2026
Supersedes	Version 1.0 (effective 1 March 2024)
Owner	HSE Manager
Approved by	COO
Next review date	1 March 2027
Applies to	Lahore warehouse, loading bays and fleet yard: all warehouse staff, drivers in the bay area, mechanics, visitors and contractors

1. Introduction

1.1 **Purpose.** These Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) set out the minimum safety rules for work in the Lahore warehouse (6,000 sq m), its 8 loading bays and the adjoining fleet yard.

1.2 **Scope.** They apply to all employees and to drivers, contractors and visitors while they are in the warehouse, bays or yard.

1.3 **Related documents** - IFL-HR-001 HR & Leave Policy (shifts, fitness after sick leave) - IFL-HR-002 Code of Conduct (alcohol and drugs, phones, discipline) - IFL-OPS-003 Driver Handbook (vehicle speed caps, vehicle checks) - IFL-SAF-005 Accident & Incident Reporting Procedure

1.4 **Definitions**

Term	Meaning
Authorised operator	A person holding a valid Company forklift authorisation under §3.2.
Bay Marshal	The person on each shift appointed by the Warehouse Supervisor to control vehicles in the loading bays.
Counterbalance forklift	Diesel forklift used in the yard and loading bays (2 units: FL-01, FL-02).
Reach truck	Electric forklift for racking aisles (2 units: RT-01, RT-02).
Exclusion zone	The 3 m area around a moving forklift that

Term	Meaning
	pedestrians must not enter.
Pedestrian walkway	Floor areas marked with green lines, reserved for people on foot.
PPE	Personal protective equipment.
SWL	Safe working load: the maximum load marked on equipment or racking.
Shift desk	The Warehouse Supervisor's desk (ext. 241).

2. Personal Protective Equipment (PPE)

2.1 **Minimum PPE.** No one may enter the warehouse floor, loading bays or fleet yard without at least a hi-vis vest and safety shoes.

Table 2.1 – PPE by area and task

Area / task	Hi-vis vest	Safety shoes	Helmet	Gloves	Other
Warehouse floor (general)	✔	✔	—	When handling goods	—
Racking aisles	✔	✔	✔	When handling goods	—
Loading bays	✔	✔	✔ when loading above head height	✔	—
Reach truck operation	✔	✔	✔	—	Seatbelt
Battery charging station	✔	✔	—	Acid-resistant gloves	Face shield or goggles, apron
Stretch-wrap / compressor room	✔	✔	—	—	Ear protection
Workshop (mechanics)	✔	✔	—	✔	Goggles for grinding/drilling
Fleet yard (on foot)	✔	✔	—	—	—

2.2 **Issue and records** - 2.2.1 PPE is issued free of charge by the Warehouse Supervisor and recorded on Form WHS-02 (PPE Issue Register). - 2.2.2 New employees receive their PPE on their first day, before they start floor work.

2.3 **Replacement** - 2.3.1 Safety shoes are replaced every 12 months, or earlier if damaged at work. - 2.3.2 Hi-vis vests are replaced when faded, torn or no longer reflective. - 2.3.3 Damaged PPE must be handed in for replacement; it is not thrown away by the employee. - 2.3.4 PPE lost (not damaged at work) within its replacement period is replaced at once, but 50% of its cost is deducted from the employee's next salary.

2.4 **Drivers and visitors.** Drivers must wear hi-vis vests and safety shoes in the bays and yard. Visitors receive a visitor vest at the gate and must be escorted (see §9).

2.5 **Non-compliance.** Supervisors must stop any person working without the required PPE. Repeated non-compliance is handled under IFL-HR-002 §9.

3. Forklift Operations

3.1 **Fleet of equipment** - 3.1.1 Counterbalance forklifts FL-01 and FL-02 (diesel, 3-tonne SWL) are used in the yard and loading bays. - 3.1.2 Reach trucks RT-01 and RT-02 (electric, 1.5-tonne SWL at maximum lift height) are used in the racking aisles. - 3.1.3 Diesel forklifts must not enter the racking aisles or the warehouse interior beyond the yellow line at the back of the loading bays, because of exhaust fumes.

3.2 **Authorisation and fitness** - 3.2.1 Only authorised operators may operate a forklift. The 4 Forklift Operators and the 2 Warehouse Supervisors (as backup) hold authorisations. - 3.2.2 Authorisation requires completing an approved forklift training course and a practical test by the HSE Manager, for each type of truck (counterbalance and reach truck are separate). - 3.2.3 Authorisations are valid for 2 years. A refresher course and practical test are required before expiry. An operator whose authorisation has expired must not operate until reassessed. - 3.2.4 Operators must pass an eyesight test every 2 years. - 3.2.5 After sick leave of more than 5 consecutive days, an operator must provide a fitness-to-work note before operating any forklift (see IFL-HR-001 §8.4.4). - 3.2.6 A newly authorised operator (including a probationer) may operate only during shifts when a Warehouse Supervisor is on the floor, for the first 20 shifts. - 3.2.7 An operator involved in any incident with injury or damage is removed from forklift duties until the HSE Manager clears them (see IFL-SAF-005 §6).

3.3 **Daily pre-use check.** At the start of each shift, the operator completes Form WHS-01 (Forklift Daily Pre-Use Check) for the truck they will use.

Table 3.3 – WHS-01 checklist summary

Item	Pass standard	If failed
Forks and carriage	No cracks, bends or excessive wear	Do not use
Mast chains and hoses	No damage or leaks	Do not use

Item	Pass standard	If failed
Brakes and parking brake	Working	Do not use
Steering	Smooth, no excessive play	Do not use
Horn, lights, reversing alarm	Working	Do not use
Seatbelt	Present and working	Do not use
Tyres	No large cuts or chunks missing	Do not use
Battery (reach trucks)	At least 30% charge; no leaks	Charge or report
Fuel level and leaks (diesel)	No leaks	Do not use if leaking
Data plate	Readable	Report

3.3.1 A truck that fails any “Do not use” item is tagged “OUT OF SERVICE” and its key is given to the shift desk. The Workshop (ext. 235) is informed. Only a Mechanic can return it to service.

3.4 **Operating rules** - 3.4.1 **Speed limits:** 8 km/h in the warehouse and yard; 5 km/h in loading bays and racking aisles. - 3.4.2 Do not exceed the SWL. Check the load weight on the consignment note before lifting. - 3.4.3 Travel with forks lowered to about 15 cm above the floor and the mast tilted back. - 3.4.4 Travel in reverse when the load blocks the forward view. - 3.4.5 Sound the horn at intersections, blind corners and doorways. - 3.4.6 No passengers. No one may be lifted on the forks or on a pallet. - 3.4.7 Keep pedestrians out of the 3 m exclusion zone. If a person enters it, stop and lower the load. - 3.4.8 Do not use a phone while operating (see IFL-HR-002 §4.7.2). - 3.4.9 Never drive a forklift onto a trailer unless the trailer is secured as described in §5.3.

3.5 **Battery charging (reach trucks)** - 3.5.1 Charging is done only at the marked charging station, with the area ventilated. - 3.5.2 No smoking, flames or sparks within 5 m of the charging station. - 3.5.3 Topping up battery water requires the PPE in Table 2.1. - 3.5.4 An eyewash station is located at the charging station and checked weekly.

3.6 **Parking.** At the end of use, park only in marked forklift bays: forks lowered to the floor, parking brake on, key removed and returned to the shift desk. Keys must never be left in an unattended truck.

4. Racking and Storage

4.1 **Load limits.** Each racking beam level displays its SWL. Pallets must not exceed this limit. If no label is visible, do not load and inform the Warehouse Supervisor.

4.2 **Floor stacking.** Pallets stacked on the floor must not exceed 3 high, and never more than 2.5 m in total height.

4.3 **Clearance.** Goods must be kept at least 1 m below sprinkler heads and must not block fire exits, extinguishers, electrical panels or pedestrian walkways.

4.4 **Racking damage** - 4.4.1 Any impact to racking must be reported to the shift desk at once, even if no damage is visible. - 4.4.2 Damaged uprights or beams are marked with red tape. The affected bay is emptied and taped off until the HSE Manager inspects it. - 4.4.3 A formal racking inspection is carried out by the HSE Officer every 3 months.

4.5 **Damaged and leaking goods.** Damaged or leaking consignments are moved to the quarantine area next to Bay 8 and recorded by the Inventory Controller. Staff must not open, sample or remove damaged goods (see IFL-HR-002 §10.2).

5. Loading Bays

5.1 **Bay allocation**

Table 5.1 – Loading bay use

Bay	Use
Bay 1	LTV vans and pickups only (last-mile dispatch)
Bays 2–7	HTV loading and unloading
Bay 8	Returns, damaged goods and quarantine; no outbound loading

5.1.1 The Warehouse Supervisor allocates bays. Drivers must not reverse onto a bay until directed by the Bay Marshal.

5.2 **Vehicle arrival** - 5.2.1 Vehicles in the bay area follow the speed limits in IFL-OPS-003 Table 3.1 (10 km/h within 50 m of the bays). - 5.2.2 Reversing onto a bay must be guided by the Bay Marshal. Drivers must not reverse unguided.

5.3 **Securing the vehicle.** Before any loading or forklift entry: - the engine is switched off and the parking brake applied; - wheel chocks are placed on both sides of the rear axle; - the driver hands the ignition key to the Bay Marshal, who hangs it on the bay key board; - the dock leveller is positioned and checked; - the Bay Marshal checks the trailer floor for damage and holes.

The key is returned to the driver only after loading is complete, doors are closed and the Bay Marshal has confirmed that no person or equipment remains in the trailer.

5.4 **Drivers during loading.** Drivers must wait in the drivers' lounge and must not stay in the cab or the bay while loading takes place, unless the Bay Marshal asks them to help check the load.

5.5 **Load planning and weight** - 5.5.1 Loads are built according to the load plan issued by the Dispatch Supervisor. Heavier pallets go at the bottom and towards the front of the trailer. - 5.5.2 No extra goods may be added that are not on the dispatch documents (see IFL-OPS-003 Table 7.2 on overloading). - 5.5.3 The load is secured with straps or load locks before the doors are closed and sealed. The seal number is recorded on the trip sheet.

5.6 **Out-of-hours loading.** Loading after Shift B ends (23:00) or before Shift A starts (07:00) requires approval from the Warehouse Manager. At least 2 trained staff must be present, one of them acting as Bay Marshal, and bay lighting must be checked before work starts.

5.7 **Restricted work.** Hot work (welding, grinding), work on dock levellers or roller doors, and work at height above 2 m in the bay area require Form WHS-03 (Loading Bay Hot-Work/Restricted Access Permit), issued by the HSE Manager or HSE Officer. A permit is valid for one shift only.

6. Manual Handling

6.1 Use pallet trucks, trolleys or forklifts wherever possible.

6.2 A single person must not lift any item heavier than 25 kg. Items between 25 kg and 50 kg require two people. Items above 50 kg must be moved mechanically.

6.3 Lift with the load close to the body, back straight and knees bent. Do not twist while carrying.

6.4 During Ramadan reduced shifts, the Warehouse Supervisor must schedule heavy manual handling in the first half of the shift where possible.

7. Housekeeping and Fire Safety

7.1 **Housekeeping.** Aisles and walkways must be kept clear. Spills are cleaned at once and the area is marked with a wet-floor sign. Shrink wrap, strapping and broken pallets are removed from the floor before the end of each shift.

7.2 **Fire safety** - 7.2.1 Fire extinguishers are checked monthly by the HSE Officer and serviced annually. - 7.2.2 Fire exits must remain unlocked during working hours and must never be blocked. - 7.2.3 Fire drills are held twice a year: once on Shift A and once on Shift B. - 7.2.4 The fire assembly point is at the fleet yard gate. - 7.2.5 Each shift has at least one trained fire warden, named on the shift roster.

7.3 **Smoking.** Smoking and naswar are prohibited in the warehouse, bays, fuel area and battery charging station (see IFL-HR-002 §4.4).

8. Incident Steps (Warehouse)

8.1 **Immediate actions** 1. Stop work and make the area safe. Switch off equipment involved. 2. Give first aid if trained. First aid kits are at the shift desk and at Bays 1, 4 and 8. 3. For serious injury, fire or a chemical spill, call emergency services and the HSE emergency line (ext. 299). 4. Inform the shift desk (ext. 241) immediately. 5. Do not move equipment or goods involved, unless needed to protect people, until the HSE Manager or HSE Officer releases the scene.

8.2 **Reporting** - 8.2.1 All injuries, property damage and dangerous occurrences are reported on Form INC-01 within 24 hours (see IFL-SAF-005 §5). - 8.2.2 Near-misses are reported on Form

INC-04 (see IFL-SAF-005 §7). - 8.2.3 Serious injuries must also be reported to the HSE Manager and the COO within 2 hours.

8.3 **Forklift incidents.** The operator is removed from forklift duty under §3.2.7 and may be tested under IFL-SAF-005 §6.

9. Visitors and Contractors

9.1 All visitors and contractors sign in at the yard gate and receive a 10-minute safety briefing and a visitor vest.

9.2 Visitors must be escorted at all times on the warehouse floor and in the bays.

9.3 Contractors carrying out repairs, cleaning or maintenance must have a WHS-03 permit where §5.7 applies, and must provide their own PPE meeting Table 2.1.

10. Training

Table 10.1 – Safety training requirements

Training	Who	When	Refresher
Warehouse safety induction (2 hours)	All warehouse staff, mechanics	Day 1	Annually
Forklift authorisation	Forklift Operators, Warehouse Supervisors	Before operating	Every 2 years
Bay Marshal training	Staff appointed as Bay Marshal	Before first appointment	Every 2 years
Fire warden training	At least 2 per shift	Within 3 months of appointment	Every 2 years
First aid	At least 1 per shift	Within 3 months of appointment	Every 3 years
Bay safety briefing	Drivers	At joining	Annually

10.1 Training records are kept by the HSE Officer. A worker whose required training has expired may not carry out that task.

11. Revision History

Version	Effective date	Summary of changes
1.0	1 March 2024	First issue
1.1	1 March 2026	Added Bay 8 quarantine use; key handover to Bay Marshal; out-of-hours loading rule (§5.6); supervised-shift rule

Version	Effective date	Summary of changes
		for new operators (§3.2.6); 50% charge for lost PPE (§2.3.4)

Fictional company — created for software demonstration only.